# Warranty and Product Quality

Document code WQ-02. Version 1.0. Effective 1 January 2024. This is a synthetic policy for the fictional company Northwind Gifts. It is used only for a software demonstration.

## 1. Scope

**1.1 What this policy covers.** This policy explains the warranty on products sold by Northwind Gifts and the quality standards that Northwind Gifts applies to its suppliers.

**1.2 Retail and wholesale.** Retail customers receive the warranty periods in Section 2. Wholesale customers receive the shorter period in clause 2.4 and the rules in Section 8.

## 2. Warranty periods

**2.1 General goods.** General goods such as homeware, stationery, toys and decorations have a warranty of 12 months from the delivery date.

**2.2 Electrical and light-up items.** Electrical items, including fairy lights, speakers and light-up decorations, have a warranty of 24 months from the delivery date.

**2.3 Ceramics and glass.** Ceramics and glassware are covered for manufacturing defects for 12 months. Breakage in transit must be reported within 7 days of delivery under the Returns and Refunds policy.

**2.4 Wholesale warranty.** All goods sold to wholesale customers have a warranty of 6 months from the delivery date.

**2.5 Replacement items.** A replacement item has the remaining warranty of the original item, or 90 days, whichever is longer.

## 3. What is covered

**3.1 Manufacturing defects.** A manufacturing defect is a fault that was present when the item was made, for example a crack, a missing part or a part that does not work.

**3.2 Not as described.** An item that does not match the description or photographs on the website is covered, for example a different size or material.

**3.3 Early failure.** An item that stops working during normal use within the warranty period is covered.

## 4. What is not covered

**4.1 Wear and tear.** Normal wear and tear, such as fading of fabric after washing or small scratches from use, is not covered.

**4.2 Misuse and accidents.** Damage caused by misuse, dropping, water damage on non-waterproof items, or use against the care label is not covered.

**4.3 Commercial use.** A retail product used in a business setting, such as a shop or a restaurant, is covered for 3 months only.

**4.4 Unauthorised repairs.** If a customer or a third party tries to repair the item, the warranty is void.

**4.5 Handmade variation.** Small differences in colour, shape or glaze on handmade items are normal and are not defects.

## 5. Remedies

**5.1 First 30 days.** If a retail item is faulty within 30 days of delivery, the customer may choose a full refund.

**5.2 After 30 days.** After 30 days and within the warranty period, Northwind Gifts first offers a repair or a replacement. If the repair or replacement fails, the customer may choose a refund.

**5.3 Out of stock.** If a replacement is out of stock, Northwind Gifts gives a refund or an equivalent item at the customer's choice.

**5.4 Postage for claims.** Return postage for warranty claims is free. Northwind Gifts sends a prepaid label.

## 6. Making a claim

**6.1 Claim form.** The customer fills in the online claim form with the order number, a description of the fault and at least 2 photographs.

**6.2 Response time.** Northwind Gifts replies to a retail claim within 10 business days. Wholesale claims are answered within 5 business days.

**6.3 Video evidence.** For electrical items, the customer must also send a short video that shows the fault.

**6.4 Repair time.** A repair is completed within 14 days after the item arrives at the repair centre. If a repair takes longer, the customer may ask for a replacement or a refund.

## 7. Quality standards

**7.1 Supplier inspection.** Northwind Gifts inspects every supplier batch before it is sold. A batch is accepted only if the defect rate is 2.5 percent or lower.

**7.2 Product recalls.** If a safety recall is needed, Northwind Gifts contacts affected customers by email within 3 business days. Recalled items are refunded in full, with no need for proof of purchase beyond the order record.

**7.3 Safety issues.** A customer who finds a safety risk, such as overheating or a small part that comes loose, must stop using the item and report it within 24 hours using the safety hotline.

**7.4 Labelling.** Items sold as food safe or child safe must carry the correct safety mark. Items without the mark are not sold under these descriptions.

## 8. Wholesale quality

**8.1 Inspection on delivery.** A wholesale customer must inspect each delivery within 48 hours and report any defect or shortage in that time.

**8.2 Defect rate credit.** If more than 3 percent of the units in a delivery are defective, Northwind Gifts gives a credit for all defective units in that delivery.

**8.3 Account manager.** Wholesale warranty claims are handled by the customer's account manager and not through the retail claim form.

## 9. Link to the Returns policy

**9.1 Faulty items and exclusions.** The exclusions for personalised items and Final Sale items in the Returns and Refunds policy do not remove the right to a remedy for a faulty item.

**9.2 No longer return window.** A warranty claim does not extend the 30 day change of mind return window. Change of mind returns are handled only under the Returns and Refunds policy.